AEP FROM ZERO • PART 2 • SPEAK TO YOUR CUSTOMER (AJO)

EPISODE 16

Adobe Journey Optimizer Tutorial for Beginners

What is Adobe Journey Optimizer, and when should you build a journey instead of a campaign? In this Adobe Journey Optimizer (AJO) tutorial for beginners, Bloom opens Act Two: AJO reuses the AEP profiles, audiences and events already built, and Kavya learns the four AJO campaign types, including API-triggered campaigns, and the three ways into a journey. She builds a Scheduled Marketing campaign draft with a first-name subject line, picks the identity type and the channel configuration,

Previously: the foundation stands

- Last time: SQL proved the load was complete
- An inner join silently dropped zero-order customers
- Act One closed: one governed foundation
- The problem now: the welcome takes six days
- Today: Adobe Journey Optimizer, AJO

KEY IDEA

Act One gave Bloom one governed customer foundation. Act Two opens on a welcome email that takes six days to arrive.

Six days to say hello

- The welcome email is a Tuesday batch job
- Pay on Wednesday, hear from Bloom six days later
- Everyone gets the same email, twice a week
- Deadline: Relaunch Monday
- Bloom Welcome v1 is the first live journey

KEY IDEA

Bloom's welcome email is a Tuesday batch job, so a customer who pays on Wednesday waits six days. The relaunch needs a welcome in a minute.

Divya's first rule: your seat, your inbox

Test seat	Whose inbox	Profile state
TD-KAVYA-01	Kavya's own	Gold
TD-FARHAN-02	Farhan's own	Silver, recent buyer
TD-DIVYA-03	Divya's own	Lapsed, over 90 days
TD-ROHAN-04	Rohan's own	Silver

Every seat is flagged as a test profile

KEY IDEA

Before anyone touches AJO, each person loads a test seat that carries their own inbox. Nobody ever types anyone else's address.

AJO sits on AEP: the voice uses the memory

Built in Act One	Used by AJO as
Real-Time Customer Profile	Who each message is for
The relaunch five audiences	Who a campaign or journey targets
Bloom's web and order events	Moments that can start a journey
Profile fields, such as first name	What each message can say

KEY IDEA

Journey Optimizer reuses the profiles, audiences and events built in Act One. Nothing is copied, and AJO reads audiences directly.

Campaign or journey? Two different questions

	Campaign	Journey
Answers	What do we send?	What happens to them next?
Shape	One send to an audience	Steps, decisions and waits
Starts from	A set time, or an API call	One of three entry styles
Built in	Campaigns	Journeys, on a canvas
Bloom example	Bloom Gold Thank-You	Bloom Welcome v1

KEY IDEA

A campaign answers “what do we send?”. A journey answers “what happens to this customer next?”, one person at a time.

The four campaign types

Campaign type	Use it for
Scheduled - Marketing	Offers and thank-yous to an audience
Scheduled - Transactional	Service notices that ignore opt-outs
API triggered - Marketing	Another system fires it, to an audience
API triggered - Transactional	Up to 20 profiles named in the call

KEY IDEA

Campaigns are Scheduled or API triggered, and Marketing or Transactional. Transactional ignores marketing opt-outs, so it is for service messages only.

Three ways into a journey

Entry	Who enters	Bloom example
Read audience	All members, once or scheduled	Gold members, every Monday
Event	One person, at the moment	Priya's 7:44 PM add to cart
Audience qualification	A person joining or leaving	Joins New This Month

KEY IDEA

A journey starts with Read audience, an event, or audience qualification. If the moment matters, use the event; if the state matters, use the audience.

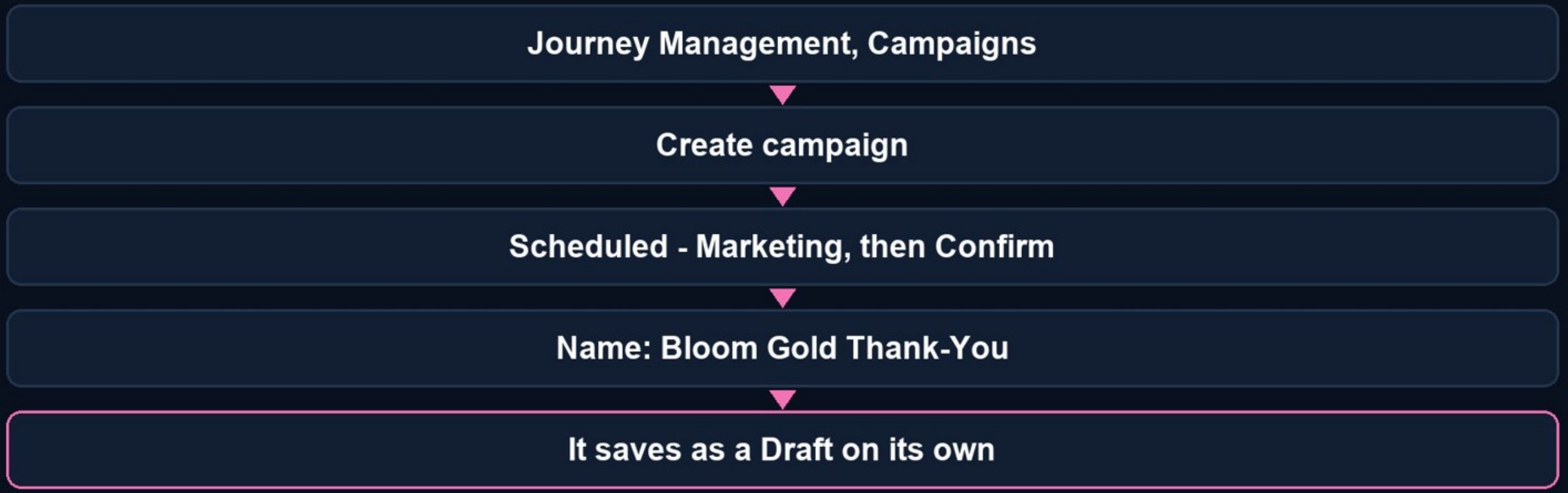
Journey or campaign: Bloom's decisions

Bloom use case	Pick	Type or door
Gold member thank-you	Campaign	Scheduled Marketing
Welcome a new customer	Journey	Audience qualification
Rescue an abandoned cart	Journey	An event
Store-closure notice	Campaign	Scheduled Transactional
Order receipt	Campaign	API triggered Transactional

KEY IDEA

Applied to Bloom: one-off sends become campaigns, and anything that reacts to one customer's moment or state becomes a journey.

Warm-up: the Bloom Gold Thank-You campaign



KEY IDEA

Kavya builds a Scheduled Marketing campaign for High-Value Loyalists. It saves as a Draft on its own, and every field saves as you type.

Identity type: one key per campaign

- Audience tab: Select audience, then Add audience
- Identity type: the key that finds each person
- Only one identity type per campaign
- No Email identity means not targeted
- Type Email first, then pick it from the list
- The address itself comes from Execution Fields

KEY IDEA

Identity type is the key AJO uses to find each person in the audience. Only one per campaign, and members without it are not targeted.

The channel configuration: chosen, not built

A channel configuration holds	Why it matters
Marketing or Transactional	Must match the campaign type
The sending subdomain	Where Bloom's mail comes from
Sender name and from address	What the customer sees
Optional recipient field	Can override Execution Fields

KEY IDEA

An admin sets up each channel configuration once: Marketing or Transactional, subdomain, sender. Marketers only select it, and the type must match.

Content: a first-name subject, structure first

Edit content

▼

Subject: first name, green tick

▼

Edit email body, Design from scratch

▼

Components: Structures, 1:1 column

▼

Then Contents: Text inside it

▼

Save, top right

KEY IDEA

Personalise the subject with the first name, then build the body. The Email Designer needs a structure before it will take any text.

Preview on your own seat: Simulate content

- Open the arrow next to Simulate content
- Pick Simulate content (AEP profiles)
- Manage test profiles: Email, your own seat
- Plain Simulate content uses sample data
- Never click Send proof here: it sends real email

KEY IDEA

Simulate content with AEP profiles previews a real test profile; plain Simulate content uses sample data. Send proof is not a preview.

Review to activate: read it, do not press it

Back arrow to the campaign

▼

Leave Schedule on its default

▼

Review to activate: read the summary

▼

One warning: opt-out link missing

▼

Do not click Activate

▼

Leave through Campaigns in the rail

KEY IDEA

Review to activate only opens a summary, so it is safe. Activate, on the default schedule, sends at once. Kavya reads, then leaves.

The Flash Sale: an API triggered campaign

Postman calls the AJO API

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API triggered Marketing campaign

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Audience: one profile, Divya's seat

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Only Divya's inbox can receive it

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Adobe documents it; check your screen

KEY IDEA

Divya fires an API triggered Marketing campaign from Postman at a one-profile audience that holds only her own test seat.

Interview corner

- A campaign answers: what do we send?
- A journey answers: what happens to this customer next?
- Proof: Bloom Gold Thank-You versus Bloom Welcome v1
- Then name the campaign type or the journey door

KEY IDEA

A campaign answers what do we send. A journey answers what happens to this customer next.

Recap, your question, and the welcome

- AJO is the voice, and it reads AEP's memory
- Campaign: what do we send? Journey: what next?
- Four campaign types, three doors into a journey
- One identity type; the address from Execution Fields
- Next: Bloom Welcome v1 on the journey canvas

KEY IDEA

AJO reuses AEP; campaigns send, journeys follow a person; a safe draft stops at Review. Next: Bloom Welcome v1 on the journey canvas.